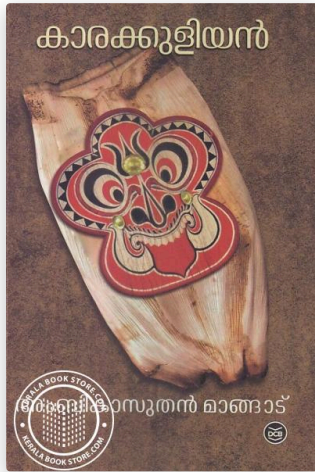


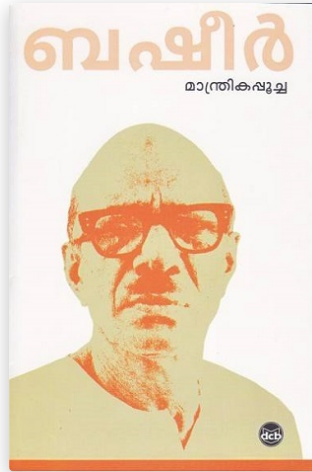
# Three Books, Three Pens

*A personal comparison of Karakkuliyan, Manthrika Poocha and Ninte Ormakku*



## **Karakkuliyan**

*Ambikasuthan Mangad*



## **Manthrika Poocha**

*Vaikom Muhammad Basheer*



## **Ninte Ormakku**

*M. T. Vasudevan Nair*

### **Karakkuliyan** — *Ambikasuthan Mangad*

Karakkuliyan is a collection of short stories written by Ambikasuthan Mangad. I came to know about him when my mom told me the story of “Two Fishes” (*Randu Malsyangal*). I became fond of his cute writing style, through which he expressed his concerns about environmental pollution and protection. As I knew the author’s cute writing style, I decided to read Karakkuliyan. But Karakkuliyan is something different. It is more rooted in Kasaragod. It has its own smell and sound. The language was a bit difficult to understand, and so were all the terms regarding theyyam and the authentic art forms of that place. But the stories told were emotional and thought-provoking. I really liked the experience of getting to know theyyam through its layers.

### **Manthrika Poocha** — *Vaikom Muhammad Basheer*

Manthrika Poocha by Basheer is a story of its own, where his pen just dances with satire and seriousness, as always. I can’t stop describing how effortlessly Basheer expresses his progressive thoughts and mature lifestyle to society, speaking loudly while keeping the emotions intact. I admire him the most.

### **Ninte Ormakku** — *M. T. Vasudevan Nair*

MT’s book is yet another collection of short stories. I felt it was more of a textbook read, rather than something having a soul. MT’s book speaks about his stepsister, who gifted him a wooden owl toy, and some of his sad childhood memories.

## Side by Side

|                      | Karakkuliyan                                                                  | Manthrika Poocha                                              | Ninte Ormakku                                                          |
|----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Author               | Ambikasuthan Mangad                                                           | Vaikom Muhammad Basheer                                       | M. T. Vasudevan Nair                                                   |
| Form                 | Collection of short stories                                                   | A story of its own                                            | Collection of short stories                                            |
| Rooted in            | Kasaragod — theyyam and the authentic art forms of that place                 | Society, seen through Basheer's progressive thoughts          | MT's childhood memories                                                |
| What it speaks about | The layers of theyyam; emotional, thought-provoking stories                   | Progressive thoughts and a mature lifestyle                   | His stepsister who gifted him a wooden owl toy; sad childhood memories |
| Writing style        | A pen of his own; different from his cute style — has its own smell and sound | A pen of his own; dances with satire and seriousness          | A generic one                                                          |
| Language             | A bit difficult to understand, with many theyyam terms                        | Effortless, speaking loudly while keeping the emotions intact | Felt like a textbook read                                              |
| How I felt           | Really liked the experience                                                   | I admire him the most                                         | Felt it lacked a soul                                                  |

Both Basheer and Ambikasuthan Mangad have a pen of their own. But MT's style is just a generic one. That's what I felt.